Informatica® Cloud Application Integration
April 2025

Azure AI Search Connector Guide

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Preface

Read the *Azure AI Search Connector Guide* to learn how to set up and use an Azure AI Search connection to manage and query indexes and documents, and manage other resources on a search service. This guide assumes that you have an understanding of the Azure AI Search API concepts.

CHAPTER 1

Introduction to Azure AI Search Connector

Azure AI Search Connectors are essential components that enable seamless integration between Azure AI Search and various data sources. Azure AI Search Connector facilitates the ingestion of data into the search index, allowing organizations to efficiently manage and search large volumes of information.

You can use Azure AI Search Connector to achieve use cases related to e-commerce, content management, and creating knowledge bases for customer support.

Azure AI Search Connector provides the following key features:

- Allows direct integration with multiple data sources, such as, Azure Blob Storage, Azure SQL Database, Cosmos DB, Azure Table Storage, and Custom Data Sources.
- Indexers automate the data extraction and indexing process. Indexers periodically review the connected data sources and update the Azure Search index with new or modified content. You can set a schedule for the indexer to run at regular intervals.
- Skillsets allows you to define a series of cognitive skills that enrich your data during indexing. It includes text analysis, image processing, and custom skills which means you can create and integrate your own skills using Azure Functions or other services.
- Provides REST APIs and SDKs (for languages like .NET, Python, and Java) that allow developers to manage indexes, indexers, and skillsets programmatically, and query the search index to retrieve and display search results.

Azure AI Search overview

Azure AI Search is a cloud-based search-as-a-service solution that helps developers integrate modern search capabilities into their applications. It combines traditional search functionality with AI-driven features to enhance users' search experience.

You can use Azure AI Search to perform the following tasks:

- Create an Azure Search Service through the Azure portal.
- Connect data sources to integrate various data sources to pull in content for indexing.
- Define indexes to specify how data is organized and searched.
- Set up indexers to automate the process of data extraction and indexing.
- Utilize REST APIs or SDKs to integrate search capabilities into your applications.
- Monitor usage and performance, gaining insights into how users interact with search functionalities.

CHAPTER 2

Azure AI Search connections

Use an Azure AI Search connection to manage and query indexes and documents, and manage other resources on a search service.

Azure AI Search Connector has a variety of actions related to CRUD operations for assets, such as DataSource, Indexer, Indexes, Skillset, and Documents. Other than CRUD operations, it has other useful actions such as Run Indexer, Search Documents, and so on. For more information about the list of actions that you can use with Azure Search AI Connector, see "Publishing Azure AI Search connections" on page 9.

After you create an Azure AI Search connection, you can validate, test, and save the connection.

You can then publish the Azure AI Search connection and click the **Metadata** tab to view the generated process objects for the connection.

Basic connection properties

The following table describes the basic properties that you can configure on the **Properties** tab of the connection creation page:

Property	Description
Name	Required. Unique name for the Azure AI Search connection that identifies it in the Process Designer. The name must start with an alphabet and can contain only alphabets, numbers, and hyphens (-).
Location	The location of the project or folder where you want to save the connection. Click **Browse** to select a location. If the **Explore** page is currently active and a project or folder is selected, the default location for the connection is the selected project or folder. Otherwise, the default location is the location of the most recently saved asset.
Description	Optional. Description of the connection.
Type	Required. The type of connection you want to use for the connector or service connector. Select **Azure AI Search**.
Runtime Environment	Required. The runtime environment for the connection. You can run the connection on the Cloud Server, a Secure Agent group, or a Secure Agent machine.

Property	Description
Connection Test	Not supported for Azure AI Search Connector.
OData-Enabled	Not supported for Azure AI Search Connector.

Azure AI Search connection properties

To use the Azure AI Search API, you need a host name and API key. All API requests must include a valid API key in the `api-key` HTTP header.

The following table defines the Azure AI Search connection properties that you must configure in the **Connection Properties** section:

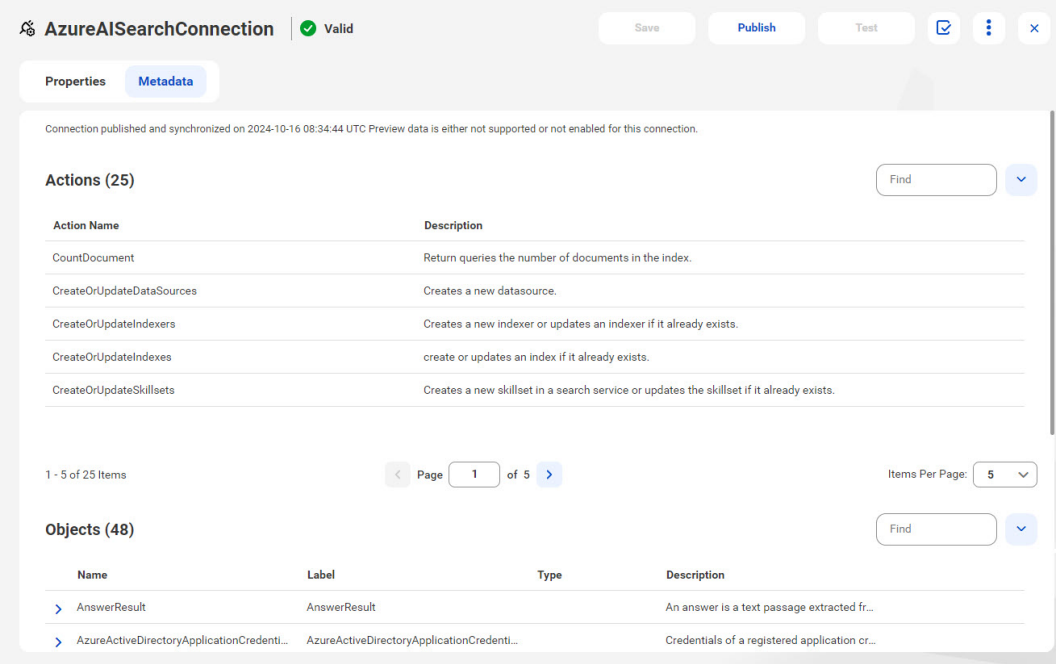
Property	Description
Host_Name	Required. The host name of the search service that you want to connect to. You can find the value in **Microsoft Azure Search Service** > **Overview**, and copy the **Url** field value.
API_Key	Required. The admin API key to authenticate Azure AI Search connection requests. You can find the value in **Microsoft Azure search service** > **Settings** > **Keys**, and copy the primary or secondary admin key.

Azure AI Search connection metadata

After you create an Azure AI Search connection, you can validate and save the connection. You can then publish the Azure AI Search connection and click the **Metadata** tab to view the generated process objects for the connection.

When you publish an Azure AI Search connection in Application Integration, the **Actions** and **Objects** appear on the **Metadata** tab.

The following image shows the **Metadata** tab for a published Azure AI Search connection:



Publishing Azure AI Search connections

When you publish an Azure AI Search connection in Application Integration, the **Actions** and **Objects** appear on the **Metadata** tab.

Consider the following information when you use specific actions and objects:

- The **Get Indexes** action retrieves the index definition. You must specify the name of the index that you want to retrieve and the API version to get the index details in the response.
  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Get Indexes** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Delete Indexes** action deletes a search index and all the documents it contains. This operation is permanent, with no recovery option. Ensure that you have a master copy of your index definition, data ingestion code, and a backup of the primary data source in case you need to rebuild the index.
  You must specify the index name that you want to delete and the API version. On successful deletion, you will receive the `204 No Content` status code in the response.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Delete Indexes** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Create Or Update Indexes** action creates an index with the given details or updates an existing index. You must specify the index name and the API version. The index details must be of the SearchIndex PO type.

  Note: Azure AI Search Connector in Application Integration does not support the `@odata.type` key. You must provide the `odataType` key instead.

  If fields in the `requestBody` need to be in different formats, you must add additional namespaces as shown in the following sample code:

```
<root xmlns:m="urn:informatica:ae:xquery:json2xml:meta-data">
<name>hotels</name>
```

```
<fields m:isArray="true">
<name>HotelId</name>
<type>Edm.String</type>
<key m:type="xs:boolean">true</key>
<filterable m:type="xs:boolean">true</filterable>
</fields>
<fields>
<name>HotelName</name>
<type>Edm.String</type>
<searchable m:type="xs:boolean">true</searchable>
<filterable m:type="xs:boolean">false</filterable>
<sortable m:type="xs:boolean">true</sortable>
<facetable m:type="xs:boolean">false</facetable>
</fields>
<fields>
<name>Description</name>
<type>Edm.String</type>
<searchable>true</searchable>
<filterable m:type="xs:boolean">false</filterable>
<sortable m:type="xs:boolean">false</sortable>
<facetable m:type="xs:boolean">false</facetable>
<analyzer>en.microsoft</analyzer>
</fields>
<fields>
<name>Category</name>
<type>Edm.String</type>
<searchable m:type="xs:boolean">true</searchable>
<filterable m:type="xs:boolean">true</filterable>
<sortable m:type="xs:boolean">true</sortable>
<facetable m:type="xs:boolean">true</facetable>
</fields>
<fields>
<name>Tags</name>
<type>Collection(Edm.String)</type>
<searchable m:type="xs:boolean">true</searchable>
<filterable m:type="xs:boolean">true</filterable>
<sortable m:type="xs:boolean">false</sortable>
<facetable m:type="xs:boolean">true</facetable>
<analyzer>tagsAnalyzer</analyzer>
</fields>
<fields>
<name>Rating</name>
<type>Edm.Double</type>
<filterable m:type="xs:boolean">true</filterable>
<sortable m:type="xs:boolean">true</sortable>
<facetable m:type="xs:boolean">true</facetable>
</fields>
<fields>
<name>Address</name>
<type>Edm.ComplexType</type>
<fields>
<name>City</name>
<type>Edm.String</type>
<searchable m:type="xs:boolean">true</searchable>
<filterable m:type="xs:boolean">true</filterable>
<sortable m:type="xs:boolean">true</sortable>
<facetable m:type="xs:boolean">true</facetable>
</fields>
<fields>
<name>Country</name>
<type>Edm.String</type>
<searchable m:type="xs:boolean">true</searchable>
<filterable m:type="xs:boolean">true</filterable>
<sortable m:type="xs:boolean">true</sortable>
<facetable m:type="xs:boolean">true</facetable>
</fields>
</fields>
<suggesters m:isArray="true">
<name>sg</name>
<searchMode>analyzingInfixMatching</searchMode>
```

```
<sourceFields m:isArray="true">HotelName</sourceFields>
<sourceFields m:isArray="true">Description</sourceFields>
</suggesters>
<analyzers m:isArray="true">
<odataType>#Microsoft.Azure.Search.CustomAnalyzer</odataType>
<name>tagsAnalyzer</name>
<charFilters m:isArray="true">html_strip</charFilters>
<tokenizer>standard_v2</tokenizer>
</analyzers>
</root>
```

You will receive the `201 Created` status code in the response and the index details if a new index is created. If the index is updated, you will receive the `204 No Content` status code in the response.

For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Create Or Update Indexes** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.

- The **Get Statistics Indexes** action returns statistics for the given index, including a document count and storage usage. You must specify the index name for which you want to get the statistic and specify the API version.
  You will receive the `200` status code and the statistics of GetIndexStatisticsResult in the response.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Get Statistics Indexes** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Suggest Documents** action suggests documents in the index that match the given partial query text. You must specify the index name that you want to get document suggestions from and specify the API version.
  You must provide the suggest parameters object in which the search, **select**, and other parameters are available.

  You can get the suggested document only if you have any suggester configured in the index. The `suggesterName` parameter is required.

  The following snippet is a sample to build a `requestBody` object:

  ```
  <root xmlns:m="urn:informatica:ae:xquery:json2xml:meta-data">
  <filter>Rating gt 4.0</filter>
  <minimumCoverage m:type="xs:int">80</minimumCoverage>
  <orderby>Rating desc</orderby>
  <search>hote</search>
  <suggesterName>sg</suggesterName>
  <top m:type="xs:int">10</top>
  </root>
  ```

  You will receive the documents that meet the query criteria in the response.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Suggest Documents** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Search Documents** action searches for documents in the index. You must specify the index name that you want to search in and specify the API version. You must provide the search parameters object with the search query and other parameters. Otherwise, all documents will be returned.
  The following snippet is a sample to build a `requestBody` object:

  ```
  <root xmlns:m="urn:informatica:ae:xquery:json2xml:meta-data">
       <count m:type="xs:boolean">true</count>
       <filter>Rating gt 1.0</filter>
       <minimumCoverage m:type="xs:int">80</minimumCoverage>
       <orderby>Rating desc</orderby>
       <search>tranquil ambiance</search>
       <searchFields>Category,Description</searchFields>
       <select>HotelName</select>
       <captions>none</captions>
  </root>
  ```

  You will receive the documents that meet the query criteria in the response.

For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Search Documents** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.

- The **Lookup Document** action retrieves a document from Azure AI Search. You can retrieve any document from the index with the document ID.
  The index name, document key, and API version are the required fields. If you want to retrieve any particular field(s) value, you specify it in the **select** field. You can specify a list of comma-separated fields to retrieve the documents. The default value of the **select** field is *. You will receive the document in the response if it exists.
- The **Create Or Update DataSource** action creates the data source with the given details or updates the data source if it exists. You must specify the data source name and the API version. Data source details must be of the SearchIndexerDataSource PO type.
  The following snippet is a sample to build a `requestBody` object:

```
<root xmlns:m="urn:informatica:ae:xquery:json2xml:meta-data">
<name>hotel-ds</name>
<description>My Azure hotel table data source.</description>
<type>azuretable</type>
<credentials>
<connectionString>DefaultEndpointsProtocol=https;AccountName=rnddev;AccountKey=Ax/
ibOkbZ06jklzGfTrM9+AStGCdv7Q==;EndpointSuffix=core.windows.net</connectionString>
</credentials>
<container>
    <name>hotelDetails</name>
</container>
<dataDeletionDetectionPolicy>
    <odataType>#Microsoft.Azure.Search.SoftDeleteColumnDeletionDetectionPolicy</
odataType>
    <softDeleteColumnName>isDeleted</softDeleteColumnName>
    <softDeleteMarkerValue >true</softDeleteMarkerValue>
</dataDeletionDetectionPolicy>
</root>
```

  You will receive the `201 Created` status code and the data source details if a new data source is created. If the data source is updated, you will receive the `204 No Content` status code.

  Note: Azure AI Search Connector in Application Integration does not support the `@odata.type` key. You must provide the `odataType` key instead.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Create Or Update DataSource** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **List DataSources** action lists all the data sources available for a search service.
  The API version is the required parameter. In the **select** field, you can specify the field names that you want to retrieve. You can specify a comma-separated list of JSON property names, or * for all the properties. The default is all properties.

  The response returns a list of SerchIndexerDataSource PO types.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **List DataSource** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Get DataSource** action retrieves a data source definition of a particular data source by name.
  The data source name and API version are the required fields. The data source details will be retrieved in the response if the data source exists.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Get DataSource** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Delete DataSource** action deletes the data source if it exists in the search service. This operation is permanent, with no recovery option.
  The data source name and API version are the required fields. On successful deletion, you will receive the `204 No Content` status code in the response.

For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Delete DataSource** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.

- The **List Indexes** action lists all the indexes available for a search service.
  The API version is the required field. In the **select** field, you can specify the field names that you want to retrieve. You can specify a comma-separated list of JSON property names, or * for all the properties. The default is all properties. The response returns a list of SerchIndex PO types.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **List Indexes** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **List Indexers** action lists all indexers available for a search service.
  The API version is the required field. In the **select** field, you can specify the field names that you want to retrieve. You can specify a comma-separated list of JSON property names, or * for all the properties. The default is all properties. The response returns a list of SerchIndexer PO types.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **List Indexers** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Create Or Update Indexers** action creates a new indexer or updates an indexer if it already exists. You must specify the indexer name and the API version. The indexer details must be of the SearchIndexer PO type.

  The following snippet is a sample to build a `requestBody` object:

  ```
  <root xmlns:m="urn:informatica:ae:xquery:json2xml:meta-data">
  <name>hotels-indexer</name>
  <description>a indexer for hotels</description>
  <dataSourceName>hotel-ds</dataSourceName>
  <targetIndexName>hotels</targetIndexName>
  <schedule>
      <interval>PT1H</interval>
      <startTime>2024-01-01T00:00:00Z</startTime>
  </schedule>
  <parameters>
      <maxFailedItems m:type="xs:int">10</maxFailedItems>
      <maxFailedItemsPerBatch m:type="xs:int">5</maxFailedItemsPerBatch>
  </parameters>
  </root>
  ```

  You will receive the `201 Created` status code and the indexer details if a new indexer is created. If the indexer is updated, you will receive the `204 No Content` status code in the response.

  Note: Azure AI Search Connector in Application Integration does not support the `@odata.type` key. You must provide the `odataType` key instead.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Create Or Update Indexers** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Delete Indexer** action deletes the indexer if it exists in the search service. This operation is permanent, with no recovery option.
  The indexer name and API version are the required fields. On successful deletion, you will receive the `204 No Content` status code in the response.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Delete Indexer** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Get Indexer** action retrieves an indexer definition by name.
  The indexer name and API version are the required fields. The indexer details of the SearchIndexer PO type are retrieved if the indexer exists.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Get Indexer** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Get Status Indexer** action returns the current status, last result, and execution history of an indexer.

The indexer name and API version are the required fields. If the indexer exists, the response returns a list of SearchIndexerStatus type.

For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Get Status Indexer** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.

- The **Run Indexers** action runs an indexer on demand. The indexer name and API version are the required fields. On a successful run, you will receive the `202 Accepted` status code.
  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Run Indexers** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Reset Indexer** action resets the change tracking state associated with an indexer. The indexer name and API version are the required fields. On successful reset, you will receive the `202 Accepted` status code.
  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Reset Indexer** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Create Or Update Skillsets** action creates a new skillset in a search service or updates the skillset if it already exists. You can specify the skillset name and the API version. The skillset details must be of the SearchIndexerSkillset PO type.
  The following snippet is a sample to build a `requestBody` object:

```
<root xmlns:m="urn:informatica:ae:xquery:json2xml:meta-data">
<name>demoskillset2</name>
<description>A skillset to demonstrate capabilities</description>
<skills m:isArray="true">
    <odataType>#Microsoft.Skills.Text.KeyPhraseExtractionSkill</odataType>
    <name>keyPhraseExtractionSkill</name>
    <description>Extracts key phrases from the text.</description>
    <context>/document</context>
    <inputs m:isArray="true">
        <name>text</name>
        <source>/document/mergedText</source>
    </inputs>
    <outputs  m:isArray="true">
        <name>keyPhrases</name>
        <targetName>keyPhrases</targetName>
    </outputs>
</skills>
</root>
```

  You will receive the `201 Created` status code and the skillset details if a new skillset is created. If the skillset is updated, you will receive the `204 No Content` status code in the response.

  Note: Azure AI Search Connector in Application Integration does not support the `@odata.type` key. You must provide the `odataType` key instead.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Create Or Update Skillsets** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **List SkillSets** action lists all the skillsets available for a search service.
  The API version is the required field. In the **select** field, you can specify the field names that you want to retrieve. You can specify a comma-separated list of JSON property names, or * for all the properties. The default is all properties. The response returns a list of SearchIndexerSkillset PO types.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **List SkillSets** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Get SkillSets** action retrieves a skillset definition in the search service by name.
  The skillset name and API version are the required fields. The skillset details of the SearchIndexerSkillset PO type are retrieved if the skillset exists.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Get SkillSets** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.

- The **Delete SkillSets** action deletes the skillset if it exists in the search service. This operation is permanent, with no recovery option.
  The skillset name and API version are the required fields. On successful deletion, you will receive the `204 No Content` status code in the response.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Delete SkillSets** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.
- The **Index Documents** action sends a batch of documents to insert, update, and delete in the index.
  The batch, API version, index name, and action are the required fields. The batch is a list of documents. With every document, there is an action to be performed. The actions can be upload, merge, mergeOrupload, or delete. The object must contain the fields of the document.

  Note: Azure AI Search Connector in Application Integration does not support the `@search.action` key. You must provide the `search.action` key instead.

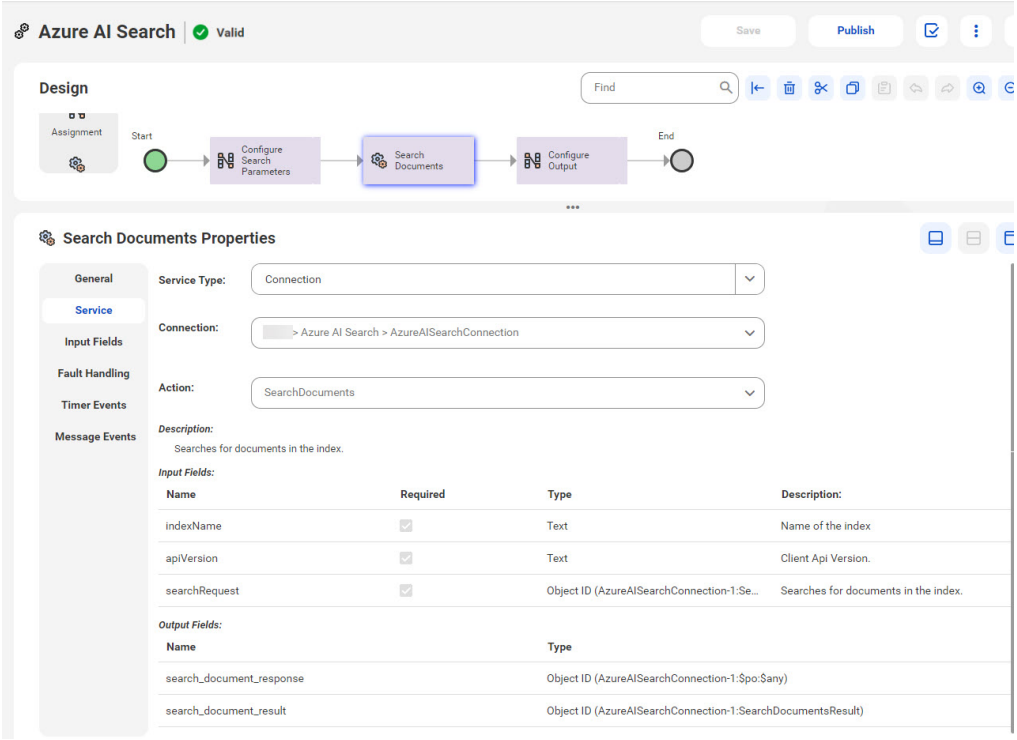
  The status, StatusCode, and ErrorMessage of the operations of all the documents in the batch are received in the response.

  For more information about configuring the parameters for the **Index Documents** action, see the Azure AI Search documentation.

Using an Azure AI Search connection in a process

After you create an Azure AI Search connection, you can use it in a Service step in a process.

1. Add a Service step to the process.
2. Click the **Service** tab.
3. From the **Service Type** list, select **Connection**.
4. From the **Connection** list, browse and select the Azure AI Search connection that you created.
5. From the **Action** list, select the action that you want to perform. For example, select the **SearchDocuments** action to search the documents in the index as shown in the following image:



In this case, Application Integration populates the **indexName**, **apiVersion**, and **searchRequest** objects under the input fields and **search_document_response** and **search_document_result** objects under the output fields.

6. Configure further steps as needed.
7. Validate, save, and publish the process.